manipulating MLAs through horse trading, creating splits and boosting rifts within parties, ultimately destroying and undermining the value of voting.

This slow destruction of regional parties silences diversity in politics, chokes representation of regional issues and centralizes power to an anti-democratic extent. Context- and region-specific decision-making is very important for a vast and diverse country such as India.

Overall, such attempts to destroy the Opposition pose a big threat to the democratic and pluralistic foundation of India.

In these dark times, the Bharat Jodo Yatra symbolizes not just a physical journey but a collective endeavour to uphold the democratic values that define our nation. It regenerates and reignites collective hope and vision. As we walk together, hand in hand, it is imperative to address the concerns that threaten the very fabric of our democracy and strive for a future where the common man emerges victorious in the face of malicious political games.

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1 'BJP Wants to Finish Off Regional Parties: Interview with H.D. Dewe Gowda, Former Prime Minister and JD(S) Chief', *The Frontline*, 10 April 2019, https://frontline.thehindu.com/cover-story/article26779494.ece